

POWER PLATFORM CASE STUDY

From scattered slides to a single source of truth

Automating a global utility program's weekly escalation
reporting with Power Apps, Power Automate, SharePoint & Power BI

≈ **6 FTEs**

of team time returned
every week, at program scale.

Power Apps · Power Automate · SharePoint · Power BI · Dataverse-ready

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THE MONDAY-MORNING PROBLEM

Forty formats, forty versions of the truth

Picture a global utilities company. Every week, the same ritual plays out. On the leadership escalation call, project dates and risk levels are decided live, in the room. Then each project manager walks away and records those decisions their own way: a personal spreadsheet, a local file, a page of notes. Before the next meeting, every PM hand-builds a PowerPoint slide summarising their projects' status, risk, and updates. Forty people. Forty layouts. Forty versions of the truth.

When someone asks, "what did we decide three weeks ago, and did it change?", the answer is buried in an old deck, if it can be found at all. There is no trail. And it doesn't end there: once the slides are in, another person sits down and manually re-keys everything (updates, risk levels, every detail) into an Excel sheet that is then pushed to the database. The same information, typed a second time, by hand, every single week.

"The slide deck had quietly become the database, and every week, a human paid the tax."

THE HIDDEN COST

Where the week actually goes

- **Fragmented ownership:** dates and risk are decided live, then scattered across forty personal trackers.
- **PowerPoint as a database:** status lives inside slides, not in anything you can query.
- **No audit trail:** history is spread across old decks; "what changed, and when" is nearly impossible to answer.
- **Manual re-keying:** a dedicated person rebuilds an Excel extract by hand and feeds the database, duplicating effort and inviting transcription errors.
- **Reporting lag:** leadership sees a snapshot compiled by hand, always a week behind.

6+ hrs

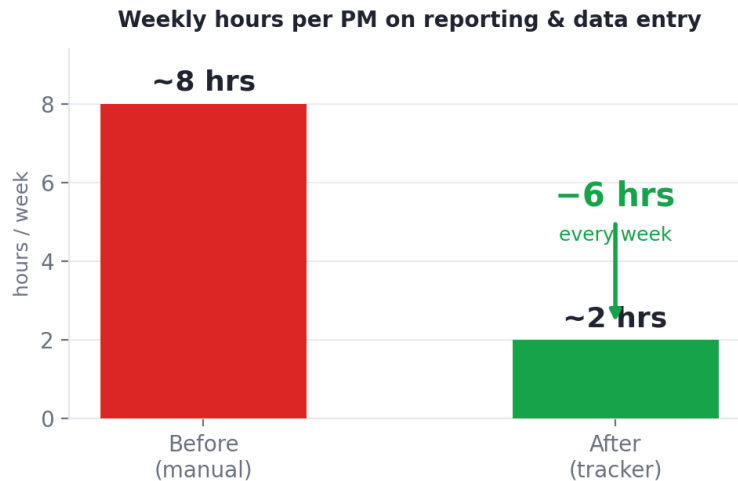
lost per PM, every week

40 PMs

doing it in parallel, globally

0

audit trail across weekly decks



Reporting and re-keying collapse from roughly eight hours a week per PM to about two.

THE REFRAME

Enter it once. Log it. Never re-type it.

The insight was simple: stop treating the slide as the system. Give every PM one place to enter a project's status, risk, and updates, with the descriptive details filled in automatically from a single master list, an append-only update log for history, and a one-click export. Then let automation do the part a person was doing by hand: writing the finished record into the data layer. No re-keying. No lost history. One source of truth that flows straight into reporting.

HOW IT WORKS

Five steps, one of them a human used to do by hand



1 • Enter once: the PM picks the project's Unique ID (multi-select) in a Power Apps canvas app and sets status, risk, and the escalation and slide flags.

2 • Auto-fill: client, site, receiving point, and team are pulled automatically from the master mapping list, so nobody retypes reference data.

3 · Log & submit: updates append to a running, timestamped log; one click saves the entry.

4 · Auto-update: a Power Automate flow fires on creation, reads the master data for each ID, and writes the complete record back into SharePoint. This is the exact task once done in Excel.

5 · Live reporting: the tracking list feeds Power BI directly, so leadership sees status in real time instead of a hand-built weekly deck.

UNDER THE HOOD

Engineered, not just assembled

A few deliberate decisions separate this from a tutorial build, and are worth a technical reader's attention:

Multi-value lookups, done right

Selected project IDs are reshaped in Power Fx with ForAll into the {Id, Value} records SharePoint expects, so one entry can carry several projects cleanly.

A trigger that won't loop

The flow runs on "when an item is created", never create-or-modify, so the automation that writes the record can't re-trigger itself.

Denormalised on purpose

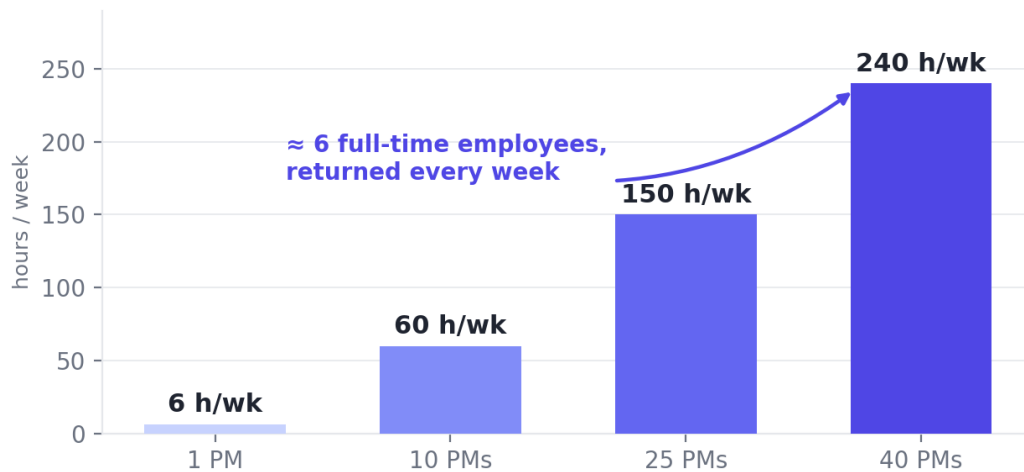
Descriptive fields are flat text, filled by the flow. It sidesteps a real SharePoint lookup limit today and is exactly the shape that migrates to Dataverse tomorrow.

THE IMPACT

Small per person. Enormous at scale.

For a single PM, the tracker saves an estimated six-plus hours a week: the reporting build plus the eliminated re-keying. That number does not stay small. Multiply it across a global program and the manual data-entry role disappears entirely.

Hours reclaimed per week as adoption scales

**240+ hrs**reclaimed across the program,
weekly**11.5k**

hours returned per year

~6 FTEs

of time, given back weekly

And beyond the hours

Reporting shifts from a weekly hand-built deck to **real-time Power BI**. Every entry is **logged and timestamped**, so the audit trail that used to be lost across decks is now built in. Re-keying disappears, and with it the **transcription errors** it introduced.

BUILT TO SCALE

SharePoint today, Dataverse when the use case earns it

SharePoint carries the solution comfortably now. As adoption grows and more data sources appear, the natural next step is Dataverse: for scale, performance, a proper relational schema, and governed, role-based security. The denormalised design already anticipates that move, so the migration is an evolution rather than a rebuild.

Now	Power Apps + Power Automate on SharePoint. Append-only update log. Live Power BI reporting.
Next	Broader roll-out across regions. Richer Power BI dashboards. Role-based views for leadership and PMs.
Later	Migrate to Dataverse for a relational schema, multi-source integration, scale, and governance, as the use case warrants.

WHAT THIS DEMONSTRATES

The skills behind the build

Canvas app design & responsive layout · Power Fx (Patch, ForAll, Filter / Search / Sort, Concat, delegation-aware queries) · Power Automate flow design (triggers, Apply to each, concurrency control, variables, join) · SharePoint data modelling · denormalisation for a future Dataverse migration · Power BI reporting · solution architecture & pragmatic problem-solving.

Built by Siddhant Singh

Turning a manual, weekly reporting grind into an automated, auditable, report-ready system, and designing it to scale.